

Molly J. Doruska

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EDUCATION

Cornell University

Ph.D. in Applied Economics and Management
M.S. in Applied Economics and Management

Expected May 2026
2022

Lawrence University

B.A in Economics & French and Francophone Studies, *summa cum laude* 2019

PUBLICATIONS

Rohr, J. R., Sack, A., Bakhoun, S., Barrett, C. B., Chamberlin, A. J., Civitello, D. J., **Doruska, M. J.**, De Leo, G. A., Forstchen, M., Haggerty, C. J. E., Jouanard, N., López-Carr, D., Lund, A. J., Ly, A. T., Seck, M., Selland, E., Sokolow, S. H., and Wolfe, C. (2025). A Planetary Health Adventure: How Removing Overgrown Water Plants Can Help Kids Stay Healthy and Improve the Planet. *Frontiers for Young Minds*. <https://doi.org/10.3389/frym.2025.1560703>.

Doruska, M. J., Barrett, C. B., and Rohr, J. R. (2024). Modeling how and why aquatic vegetation removal can free rural households from poverty-disease traps. *Proc. Natl. Acad. Sci. U.S.A.* 121 (52), e2411838121. <https://doi.org/10.1073/pnas.2411838121>.

Rohr, J. R., Sack, A., Bakhoun, S., Barrett, C. B., Lopez-Carr D., Chamberlin, A. J., Civitello, D. J., Diatta, C., **Doruska, M. J.**, De Leo, G., Haggerty, C. J. E., J Jones, I. J., Jouanard, N., Lund, A. J., Ly, A. T., Ndione, R. A., Remais, J. V., Riveau, G., Schacht, A., Seck, M., Senghor, S., Sokolow, S. H., and Wolfe, C. (2023). A planetary health innovation for disease, food, and water challenges in Africa. *Nature* 619, 782-787. <https://doi.org/10.1038/s41586-023-06313-z>.

WORKING PAPERS

Molly J. Doruska. “Flood Risk and Differential Firm Investment: Evidence from Dakar, Senegal”

Molly J. Doruska, Christopher B. Barrett, Samba Mbaye, and Jason R. Rohr. “Estimating Demand When Turning a Public Bad into an Impure Public Good”

Kira Lanker, Laksmi Iyer, Faraz Usmani, James Allen IV, **Molly J. Doruska**, Samba Mbaye, Amina Sylla, Binta Sow, Jason R. Rohr, and Christopher B. Barrett. “Do private incentives crowd out public good donations? Evidence from a lab-in-the-field experiment”

Musa Hasen Ahmed and **Molly J. Doruska**. “Paving the Way for Livestock Development: Rural Road Access and Agricultural Production in Ethiopia”

Emily K. Selland, Nicolas Jouanard, Amadou Guisse, Momy Seck, Andrea J. Lund, David Lopez-Carr, Alexandra Sack, Louis Magblenou, Guilio A. De Leo, **Molly J. Doruska**, Christopher B. Barrett, Jason R. Rohr. “Rice-Fish Co-Culturing for Sustainability, Food Security, and Disease and Poverty Reduction” *Submitted*.

WORKS IN PROGRESS

Molly J. Doruska, Brian Dillon, and Jeffrey Wall. “Changes in Surface Water Availability and Adaptation by Herders in Sub-Saharan Africa”

Christopher B. Barrett, Jason R. Rohr, Laksmi Iyer, Faraz Usmani, **Molly J. Doruska**, Nicolas Jouanard, Gilles Riveau, Samba Mbaye, Doudou Sow, Bruno Senghor, Tidjani Ly, Sidy Bakhoun, James Allen IV, and Kira Lanker. “Integrating Socio-Economic and Environmental Interventions to Improve Well-Being in Vulnerable Communities”

OTHER WRITING

Doruska, M. and Hoddinott, J. (2020) What works to reduce extreme poverty? A selective review. DEEP Working Paper 01. Data and Evidence to end Extreme Poverty Research Programme: Oxford. Available at: <https://doi.org/10.55158/DEEPWP1>.

TEACHING

Guest Lecturer, AEM 6080: Production Economics at Cornell University Fall 2025

Trip Team Leader, Field visit to Senegal for AEM 4415: Social Enterprises in Emerging Markets, Student Multidisciplinary Applied Research Teams (SMART) Program at Cornell University Winter 2025

Graduate Teaching Assistant at Cornell University

AEM 2555: Corporate Sustainability: The Business Challenge Spring 2020

AEM 4940/6940: Sustainable Business Fall 2023

AEM 2000: Contemporary Controversies in the Global Economy Spring 2024

Teaching Assistant at Lawrence University

ECON 380: Econometrics Winter 2019

ECON 223: Quantitative Decision Making Fall 2018

RESEARCH POSITIONS

Cornell University – Dyson School of Applied Economics & Management

Graduate Research Assistant for Christopher B. Barrett June 2020, June 2021 – Present

Graduate Research Assistant for John Hoddinott July 2020 – December 2020

Lawrence University

Research Assistant for Jonathan Lhost September 2018 – May 2019

GRANTS

PEDL Exploratory Research Grant, *Flood Risk and Differential Firm Investment: Evidence from Dakar, Senegal* [£31,678], 2024

STEG PhD Research Travel Grant, *Flood Risk and Differential Firm Investment: Evidence from Dakar, Senegal* [£14,161], 2024

Einaudi Center for International Studies Research Travel Grant [\$1,700], 2024

Cornell University Graduate School Research Travel Grant [\$1,550], 2024

J-PAL King Climate Action Initiative, *Adaptation to Long-Term Changes in Surface Water Availability by Herders in West Africa* [\$9,600], 2023

PRESENTATIONS

2025: AERE Summer Conference, College of the Holy Cross, 2025 Ecology and Evolution of Infectious Disease Conference, AAEA Annual Meeting, Camp Resources, Advances with Field Experiments

2024: Pacific Conference for Development Economics (PacDev), AERE Summer Conference

2023: AAEA Annual Meeting

HONORS AND AWARDS

Louis Pasteur Prize for Best PhD Student Paper, Advances with Field Experiments	2025
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George F. Warren Award, First Place, Cornell University for Doruska et al. 2025	2025
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International Champion, Frontiers Planet Prize for Rohr et al. 2023	2024
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Sustainability Science Award, The Ecological Society of America for Rohr et al. 2023	2024
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United States National Champion, Frontiers Planet Prize for Rohr et al. 2023	2024
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William A. McConagha Prize, Lawrence University (Senior student who best exhibits excellence in the study of economics)	2019
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Iden Charles Champion Award in Commerce & Industry, Lawrence University (Best economics paper)	2019
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Philip and Rosemary Wiley Bradley Achievement Scholarship in Economics, Lawrence University (Scholarship awarded to junior student to encourage talented and industrious students to major in the field of economics)	2018
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SERVICE

Referee Service, *PNAS*, *Food Policy*

Reviewer, *AERE Summer Conference 2025*, *STARS/STAARS program*

Peer Mentor, STARS/STAARS program, 2022 – 2023, 2024 – 2025

President, Applied Economics and Management Graduate Student Association, 2021 – 2022

Founder and Co-Chair, Dyson Diversity Council, 2021 – Present

President, Diversity in Cornell Economics, 2024 – 2025

Chair, Graduate Students for Gender Equity in Economics, 2023 – 2024

Vice President, Diversity in Cornell Economics, 2022 – 2023

Member, Diversity in Cornell Economics, 2021 – Present

MISCELLANEOUS

Languages: English (native); French (advanced), Wolof (beginning)

Software: Stata, R, Julia, QGIS, Google Earth Engine, SurveyCTO, LaTeX, Microsoft Office Suite

Athletic: Marathoner; Women's Open age group captain, Finger Lakes Running Club cross country team; Competed in varsity cross country, indoor, and outdoor track for Lawrence University, 2015-2019; MVP of Women's Track & Field 2019; Breakthrough female athlete of the year, Lawrence University Athletics Department, 2019

REFERENCES

Christopher B. Barrett

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Catherine Louise Kling

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